

Web Scraping - real live data from Chrome

Using the UiPath Data Scraping box on a real website (books.toscrape.com)

What this does: pulls **real, live data** (book titles + prices) from a real website through Chrome, using UiPath's **Data Scraping** wizard. books.toscrape.com is a genuine live site built for scraping practice - permitted, no login, no CAPTCHA.

Do NOT point this at MakeMyTrip / IRCTC / Goibibo - they forbid scraping and use CAPTCHA/anti-bot. The steps are the same for any site you are allowed to scrape.

0. One-time setup

- Install **Google Chrome**.
- Install the UiPath Chrome extension: Studio → Home → Tools → UiPath Extensions → Chrome → Install (then turn it On in Chrome).

1. Open the live site

In Chrome, go to **https://books.toscrape.com** - a grid of books with a title and a price (like £51.77). Keep the tab open.

2. Run the Data Scraping box (this IS the web scraping)

- 1 In Studio, open a workflow (new one, or Workflows\SearchFlights.xaml).
- 2 Ribbon: **Design** → **Data Scraping**.
- 3 Click the **title of the 1st book**, then the **title of the 2nd book** when asked.
- 4 Preview appears → name the column **Title** → **Next**.
- 5 **Extract Correlated Data?** → **Yes**: click the **1st price**, then the **2nd price**; name it **Price** → **Finish**.
- 6 Max results: enter **20** (one page) for a quick demo (or 0 + next-page to get all).
- 7 Store output as a DataTable (e.g. ExtractDataTable). Studio adds a browser scope + Extract Table Data.
- 8 Click **Run** - Chrome opens and you get a table of real, live titles + prices.

3. (Optional) Show it / find the cheapest

Prove it worked - add an **Input Dialog** (Label =):

```
"Scraped " + ExtractDataTable.Rows.Count.ToString + " books. First: " +  
ExtractDataTable.Rows(0)("Title").ToString + " - " + ExtractDataTable.Rows(0)("Price").ToString
```

Find the cheapest book - Assign cheapestRow (DataRow) =

```
ExtractDataTable.Select().OrderBy(Function(r) Cdbl(r("Price").ToString.Trim.Substring(r("Price").ToString.Trim.IndexOfAny("0123456789").ToArray()))).FirstOrDefault()
```

(The Substring/IndexOfAny trick strips the £ so the price becomes a number.) Then show cheapestRow("Title") and cheapestRow("Price") in an Input Dialog.

Note about the travel project

Books have no travel 'Fare' column, so keep the travel price comparison on DEMO data and use this books scrape as your standalone 'real web scraping' demonstration. To scrape a real travel source later it must be one that permits automation; then set in `_LiveSiteUrl` in Main.xaml and redo this wizard.

Troubleshooting

Data Scraping greyed out / does nothing	Install the UiPath Chrome extension and keep the Chrome tab focused.
Wizard won't pick the element	Click precisely on the text (title/price), not the image or card edge.
Price won't convert to number	Use the Substring/IndexOfAny expression above (removes the £).

Blocked on a real fare site

That site forbids scraping - use a permitted site like this one.